CIT305: Social Media Applications

Week 05- Chatbots & Conversational Interfaces

Activity 05

Case Study 1: Sephora's Bot on Messenger

Case Study: Sephora, the global beauty retail giant, noticed that many of their customers were using Facebook Messenger to inquire about booking makeovers. The manual process of responding to each request and scheduling appointments was time-consuming for their staff.

1. What was the primary problem Sephora's chatbot was designed to solve?

Sephora wanted to make it easier and faster for customers to book makeovers. Before the bot, customers had to wait for staff to manually reply to messages, which took time.

2. How did the chatbot improve the customer experience?

The bot made the whole process super quick and convenient customers could book a makeover in just a few taps. Plus, it offered makeup tips and tutorials, making it feel personal and helpful, like a beauty assistant available anytime.

3. What type of chatbot (rule-based or AI-powered) do you think this is, and why?

It's most likely a **rule-based chatbot** with some smart features. It follows a set flow asking for location, showing times, confirming bookings ,suggesting tutorials.

4. What are some potential challenges or limitations Sephora might have faced with this bot?

- It might not understand unusual customer questions outside the booking flow.
- Technical issues (like wrong time slots showing up) could frustrate users.
- Keeping the bot's content fresh (new tips, new store times) would need regular updates.

Case Study 2: KLM's BlueBot

Case Study: KLM Royal Dutch Airlines, known for its strong social media presence, received a massive volume of customer service inquiries through platforms like Facebook Messenger and WhatsApp. These queries ranged from flight status updates to check-in assistance and booking confirmations. Responding to every message manually was a huge operational challenge.

1. What was the main operational challenge that led KLM to develop BlueBot?

KLM faced a high volume of routine customer inquiries across platforms like Facebook Messenger and WhatsApp. These included:

- Repetitive tasks (e.g., flight status updates, booking confirmations).
- Time-sensitive requests (e.g., boarding pass retrieval before flights).
- Manual responses strained staff resources and delayed resolutions.

BlueBot was developed to automate these routine tasks, freeing up human agents for complex issues

2. How did the chatbot benefit KLM as a business?

- Cost Efficiency: Reduced labor costs by automating repetitive tasks.
- Scalability: Handled thousands of inquiries simultaneously, even during peak travel times.
- Customer Satisfaction: Provided instant, 24/7 support (e.g., real-time flight updates).
- Brand Reputation: Reinforced KLM’s image as an innovative, customer-centric airline.
- Data Insights: Collected user interaction data to improve services (e.g., identifying common pain points).

3. Why was the handover feature so crucial for BlueBot's success?
The seamless handover to human agents was critical because:

- Complex Issues: Some inquiries (e.g., rebooking due to cancellations) required human judgment.
- Customer Trust: Users frustrated by bot limitations could escalate smoothly, preventing dissatisfaction.
- Hybrid Efficiency: Optimized the balance between automation and human touch.

This feature ensured the bot complimented, rather than replaced, human support.

4. What are the differences in scope and purpose between Sephora's bot and KLM's bot?

- **Sephora’s bot** mainly focuses on booking makeovers and giving beauty tips, it’s about engagement and marketing.
- **KLM’s bot** handles lots of customer service tasks like flight info, check-ins, and boarding passes, it’s about operations and support.
  So, Sephora’s bot feels more like a “beauty assistant,” while KLM’s bot feels more like a “travel helper.”